THE ACQUISITION BIBLE

The 5 rules I run before buying a company.
Run your next deal through them.

A PLAYBOOK FOR BUYERS

[life is beta]

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5 questions before any money moves

Every company AutoDS looks at goes through the same 5 rules, in the same order. People first. Payback math only once the first 3 hold up.

USE IT WHEN

- A founder asks if you would buy their company
- A product shows up that you planned to build anyway
- You feel the deal before you have the numbers

WHAT YOU NEED ON THE TABLE

- The asking price
- Monthly profit today
- An honest list of what you would fix on day one

The whole Bible on one page

01

People I trust

A real link to the founders. Trust comes before the spreadsheet.

02

Value we can add

We make it more profitable or we make the product better.

03

A gap in our ecosystem

A complementary product that closes a hole for our customers.

04

Payback in 12 months

After our fixes, the deal returns the investment within a year.

05

A product we know

Usually something we planned to build anyway. Buying saves time and focus.

People I trust

> "It starts with a connection to people I trust."

ANSWER BEFORE THE FIRST CALL

- Who on our side knows the founders personally?
- Would we hire these people if the company did not exist?
- Will they keep working hard once the money is in the bank?

FILL IN

Who we know there [Name, role]

How we know them [Years, context]

Who vouches for them [Name]

Trust score [1 to 5]

Value we can add

> "We know how to add value. Either improving profitability or improving the product."

ANSWER BEFORE THE FIRST CALL

- Which lever do we pull first, profit or product?
- What do we already do better than they do?
- What does monthly profit look like after the fix?

FILL IN

Main lever [Profit / Product]

Day-one fixes [3 bullets]

Profit today, monthly [$X]

Profit after fixes, monthly [$Y]

A gap in our ecosystem

> "What does our ecosystem get from it? A complementary product that fills the holes."

ANSWER BEFORE THE FIRST CALL

- Which gap between our features does it close?
- Would our customers use both products together?
- What can our customers do after the deal that they cannot do today?

FILL IN

The gap it closes [One sentence]

Customer overlap [X%]

What it unlocks [One sentence]

Fit score [1 to 5]

Payback in 12 months

> "If I can get the investment back within a year, I'm buying."

THE PAYBACK MATH

A · Asking price	[$_____]
B · Monthly profit after our fixes	[$_____]
A ÷ B = months to payback	**[____]**

12 OR LESS · BUY

OVER 12 · PASS

WHY AFTER THE FIXES

- Use the profit after rule 02, once the fixes are in
- That is the number you are paying for
- If you cannot name the fixes, use today's profit

A product we know

> "We don't buy something we don't know. Usually it's something we planned to build anyway, and it saves us time and focus."

ANSWER BEFORE THE FIRST CALL

- Is this on our roadmap already?
- How long would building it take our team?
- What would that team build instead?

FILL IN

On our roadmap [Yes / No]

Time to build it ourselves [Months]

Team it frees up [Who]

What they ship instead [One sentence]

What the seller needs from you

> "Every deal we do runs on targets. They need to trust that together, we hit them."

YOUR JOB IN THE ROOM

- Show the targets and how you hit them together
- Show why it pays them more than running alone
- Be honest about what happens if they say no

THE HONEST PART

Sometimes the seller already knows you are entering their space anyway. Say it plainly. A seller who sees the whole picture decides faster.

The deals I regret are the ones we skipped

> "I didn't take enough risk. Same playbook, we knew what we were doing. We should have taken the loan."

If a deal passes all 5 rules, the cash in the bank is the last reason to say no.

Run every deal through this page

#	RULE	THE QUESTION	PASS?
01	**People I trust**	Do we have a real link to the founders, and would we hire them?	☐ Yes ☐ No
02	**Value we can add**	Can we name the fixes that raise profit or improve the product?	☐ Yes ☐ No
03	**A gap in our ecosystem**	Does it close a hole our customers feel today?	☐ Yes ☐ No
04	**Payback in 12 months**	Asking price ÷ monthly profit after fixes = 12 or less?	☐ Yes ☐ No
05	**A product we know**	Was it on our roadmap anyway?	☐ Yes ☐ No

5 OF 5 · MAKE THE OFFER

ANY NO · FIX IT OR WALK

Copy the rules.
Run your next deal through them.

More playbooks from inside AutoDS at follow.liorpozin.com

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